Victor Morales-Bobier

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Research Interests: Public Economics, Labor Economics, Wealth and Income Inequality

Education

London School of Economics Sept 2026 – July 2027 (exp.)
MSc, Econometrics and Mathematical Economics

- **Coursework:** Advanced Microeconomics, Advanced Macroeconomics, Econometric Analysis, Public Economics

Western University – Huron University College Sept 2022 – May 2026
BA, Honours Specialization in Economics, with Distinction

- GPA: 3.87/4.0 (90% cumulative average); ranked 1st of 36
- **Graduate Coursework:** PhD Macroeconomics (A+; only undergraduate enrolled), Stochastic Financial Modelling, Time Series Analysis and Forecasting, Advanced Data Analysis
- **Quantitative Coursework:** Econometrics I & II, Machine Learning, Market Microstructure & High-Frequency Trading, Mathematical Economics, Linear Algebra, Research Methods, Sample Design

Research Experience

Research Assistant, Dr. Ian Herzog – Huron University College Jan 2025 – Sept 2025

- Urban and housing economics projects on commuter mode choice, housing supply responses, rent control, and international student migration
- Worked with confidential census microdata in the Statistics Canada Research Data Centre (RDC), alongside transportation and administrative data
- Combined multiple census waves into longitudinal datasets of millions of observations using Python and R; produced summary statistics, figures, and regression estimates

Research Assistant, Dr. Michael Kottelenberg – Huron University College Sept 2024 – April 2026

- Built R web-scraping pipelines to assemble data on public library usage and educational achievement; cleaned and aggregated the data and ran the project's regression analyses

Selected Coursework Projects

Limited Marital Commitment and Tenure Choice August 2026

- Simplified adaptation of limited-commitment life-cycle models (Addoum, Kung & Morales 2016; De Rock et al. 2023) of intra-household bargaining, housing, labor supply, and divorce
- Solved by backward induction and forward simulation; examined how spousal income gaps, income risk, and housing transaction costs affect divorce and homeownership

Predicting Market Stress Using Liquidity and Market Signals April 2026

- Built a daily panel from CRSP (via WRDS) covering the 500 largest US firms, 2010–2023, constructing 69 predictors including Amihud illiquidity, volume concentration, and SPY bid-ask spreads and realized volatility
- Compared penalized regression (LASSO, Ridge, elastic net), tree-based, and nonparametric classifiers in R for one-day-ahead stress prediction; regularized linear models performed best out of sample (AUC ≈ 0.935)

Awards & Honors

Robert C. Douglas Scholarship in Economics (£15,000), for a Canadian LSE MSc entrant 2026
John Cronyn Third-Year Scholarship (C$1,300), top second-year Honours student in Economics 2025
Godsoe Family Scholarship of Distinction (C$7,200), academic excellence in Economics 2024
Huron University College Entrance Scholarship (C$12,000) 2022
Dean's List (4×) 2023–2026

Skills & Languages

Programming: Python, R, VBA; Stata and MATLAB (MSc coursework, in progress)

Data: CRSP/WRDS; confidential Statistics Canada census microdata (RDC)

Languages: English (Fluent), Spanish (B2), French (A1)